

LeaveFlow

How to run and stop the system

Version **main @ b5ebb85**

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Audience **anyone running the demo**

LeaveFlow is the leave-management web app for Ceylon Roots (Pvt) Ltd: employees apply for full or half days, managers approve, and HR manages the public-holiday calendar. This guide explains how to turn the system on, open it, turn it off without losing data, and fix the most common problems.

OPEN THE APP

`http://localhost:8080`

TURN ON

`docker compose up -d`

TURN OFF

`docker compose down`

1. Before you start

You need	Details
Docker Desktop	Installed and signed in. Used to run the database, the API and the web app together.
Git Bash	All commands in this guide are typed into Git Bash.
The project folder	<code>E:\leaveflow</code> (in Git Bash: <code>/e/leaveflow</code>).
Node.js 24 (backup only)	Only needed to run the system without Docker (section 6).

2. Turn the system on

1 Start Docker Desktop. Open it from the Start menu and wait until the bottom-left corner says **Engine running**.

2 Open Git Bash and start LeaveFlow:

```
cd /e/leaveflow
git pull
docker compose up -d --build
```

This builds and starts three parts: **db** (PostgreSQL database), **api** (the server) and **web** (the website). The first run takes a few minutes; later runs take seconds.

3 Prepare the database (first time, or after an update). Safe to run every time; it only applies what is missing:

```
docker compose exec api npm run migrate
docker compose exec api npm run seed
```

4 Check it is running:

```
docker compose ps
```

You should see `db ... (healthy)`, `api ... Up` and `web ... Up 0.0.0.0:8080->80`.

3. Open the app and log in

Open **`http://localhost:8080`** in your browser. All demo accounts use the password `password123`.

Email	Role	Can do
ishara@ceylonroots.lk	Employee	Apply for leave (full or half day), cancel pending requests, see balances
ruwan@ceylonroots.lk	Manager	Approve or reject his team's requests, see who else is off, history
dilini@ceylonroots.lk	HR	See all requests, export CSV, manage the public-holiday list

4. Turn the system off (data is kept)

```
cd /e/leaveflow
docker compose down
```

This stops and removes the containers. All leave requests, balances and holidays stay saved in the Docker volume `leaveflow_dbdata`. You can also quit Docker Desktop afterwards.

Never use `docker compose down -v`

The `-v` option deletes the database volume, so every request, balance and holiday added through the app is lost.

5. Turn it on again later

1 Open Docker Desktop and wait for **Engine running**.

2 In Git Bash:

```
cd /e/leaveflow
docker compose up -d
```

3 Open **`http://localhost:8080`**. Your data is still there.

After pulling new code

Add `--build` (`docker compose up -d --build`) and run the two database commands from step 2.3, so the app shows the newest screens.

6. Backup: run without Docker

Use this if Docker Desktop will not start. It runs the same app with a built-in database.

Turn on

```
cd /e/leaveflow
npm install
npm run dev
```

Wait for [dev] open `http://localhost:5173`, then open **`http://localhost:5173`**. The logins are the same.

Turn off

Press `Ctrl` + `C` in the Git Bash window. Data is kept in `server/.pgdata` and is there the next time you run `npm run dev`.

Note

The Docker version (port 8080) and the backup version (port 5173) use separate databases. Pick one for a demo and stay with it.

7. Quick fixes

Problem	Fix
failed to connect to the docker API	Docker Desktop is not running. Open it and wait for Engine running , then run the command again.
Docker Desktop shows an error about <code>dockerInference ... cannot be accessed by the system</code>	In Docker Desktop open Settings → AI , untick Enable Docker Model Runner and Docker AI (Ask Gordon) , then Apply & restart . Or run <code>docker desktop disable model-runner</code> . Meanwhile, use the backup in section 6.
Port 8080 is already in use	An older copy is still running: <code>docker compose down</code> , then start again. To see what holds the port: <code>netstat -ano grep :8080</code> .
Login says "Wrong email or password"	The database has no demo data yet: run <code>docker compose exec api npm run migrate</code> and <code>docker compose exec api npm run seed</code> .
The page shows old screens (no Morning / Afternoon, no Holidays tab)	Rebuild: <code>git pull && docker compose up -d --build</code> , then press <code>Ctrl</code> + <code>Shift</code> + <code>R</code> in the browser.
Something fails during a demo	Read the server log before anything else: <code>docker compose logs -f api</code> (stop watching with <code>Ctrl</code> + <code>C</code>).

8. Five-minute demo

Time	Do	Point out
0:00	Introduce the two requests: half days that cost 0.5, and public holidays that are never charged.	Half days are stored as Full / AM / PM, so managers see which half.
0:30	Log in as Ishara . Note the Annual balance (e.g. 13).	"Watch this drop by exactly 0.5."
1:00	Apply: Annual, start and end 2026-10-09, Afternoon , reason "School meeting", Submit request .	"= 0.5 working days"; My requests shows "2026-10-09 PM · 0.5 days".
2:00	Log in as Ruwan → Approvals . Click Approve .	The card shows a PM badge and "Annual balance 13 → 12.5 after".
2:45	Log in as Ishara again.	Status APPROVED; Annual remaining 12.5 .
3:15	Log in as Dilini → Holidays . Add 2026-12-31 , "Special bank holiday".	25 holidays for 2026; the new one appears in the list.
4:00	All requests → Export CSV .	The file shows the Day part (PM) and working days that skip holidays.
4:30	Questions.	Next: the New Year shutdown week, and a half day at the start of a trip.

If the form says the dates overlap, 2026-10-09 is already booked in this database: choose another weekday. After the demo, log in as Dilini and delete the 2026-12-31 holiday.

9. Command summary

Task	Command (in <code>/e/leaveflow</code>)
Turn on (first time / after update)	<code>docker compose up -d --build</code>
Prepare the database	<code>docker compose exec api npm run migrate</code> <code>docker compose exec api npm run seed</code>
Check status	<code>docker compose ps</code>
See the server log	<code>docker compose logs -f api</code>
Turn off (keep data)	<code>docker compose down</code>
Turn on again	<code>docker compose up -d</code>
Backup without Docker	<code>npm install && npm run dev</code> → <code>http://localhost:5173</code> (stop with Ctrl + C)